



## **IARCO Research Proposal Marks Distribution and Rules**

| <b>Section</b>             | <b>Context</b>                                                                                                      | <b>Maximum Points</b> |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <b>Research Problem</b>    | What is the background of this problem? Is the need for research clearly identified?                                | <b>20</b>             |
| <b>Existing Literature</b> | What has been written about your topic before? Is the existing body of knowledge clearly addressed?                 | <b>10</b>             |
| <b>Research Question</b>   | Does your proposal contain a central research question? Is the question specific enough?                            | <b>25</b>             |
| <b>Methodology</b>         | How will this research be conducted? Is the methodology clearly laid out?                                           | <b>25</b>             |
| <b>Research Topic</b>      | Is the topic creative, innovative, and/or urgent? Does the proposal justify the need to research this topic?        | <b>15</b>             |
| <b>Quality of Writing</b>  | Is the proposal free of grammatical errors?<br>Is the writing clear? Is it directed toward an appropriate audience? | <b>5</b>              |

## **Research Proposal Submission Guidelines—IARCO:**

- Students from all disciplines, including Medical, Humanities, STEM, and others.
- However, submissions must be original and must not include any institutional logos or professor names. Submitting a thesis project, proposal, or video pitch that includes such references will result in disqualification without prior notice.
- Proposals generated using AI or large language models will also be disqualified without prior notice.
- We require all submissions to follow the IEEE in-text citation and reference style. Using any other citation style will result in significant point deductions.
- We utilize leading plagiarism detection tools used by top research institutions, including AI-specific checks (e.g., iThenticate). A non-repository checker is used, so your work remains private after the competition, except for the Top 20 proposals, which will be publicly accessible. A detailed scoreboard will be available only for the winners.
- Submission Requirements:
  - A mandatory cover page including: Full Name, Institution, Class/Grade/Year, Country, Major (if senior), and Submission Date.
  - Only category toppers will be invited for a Video Pitch Round and notified via our official website and email.
- Please download our Research Proposal Template before submitting:  
[https://iarco.org/assets/doc/proposal\\_template.docx](https://iarco.org/assets/doc/proposal_template.docx)
- For guidance, refer to last year's winning proposal available on our website. More question visit our FAQ Section:  
<https://iarco.org/faq>